



World's Fastest Fibre Network

Danish researchers have created a fibre network capable of transferring 43 TeraBits per second (1 GB movie download in 0.2 milliseconds) <http://dgit.in/DanFibNet>



Cannot Compute

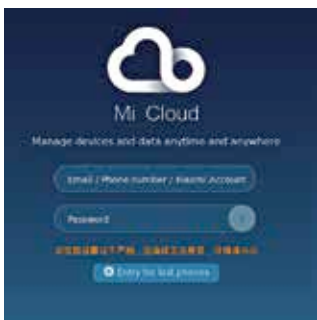
An article that gives you the low down on information overload, its causes and how it spreads. <http://dgit.in/Infogineering>

Being on guard

We take a look at the top cyber security stories of the month

Should you be wary of Chinese smartphones? Are security concerns about the Chinese smartphones overblown? Internet has been abuzz with these questions after it was alleged that devices made by Xiaomi, China's top smartphone player, were covertly sending users data to China. Following a wide controversy over security concerns, Xiaomi was compelled to make its cloud messaging service optional on its devices.

Xiaomi VP of international affairs Hugo Barra put up a post on Google Plus, explaining that the company is allowing users to opt out of the service if they wish to. The Mi Cloud messaging service is similar to Apple's iMessage service, which allows Apple's iPhone users to send free messages to each other through



Mi Cloud

the Internet. Mi Cloud messaging does the same for users of Xiaomi's smartphones.

Earlier, security firm F-Secure found that the Xiaomi service seemed to be sharing information with a server in China. This included information like the users IMEI numbers, phone contacts, phone

number and the text messages that the device received. This has raised concern amongst users about their data being accessible to the Chinese government.

Russian hackers conduct world's biggest Internet security breach

According to a report published by Hold Security, Russian hackers stole over 1.2 billion user names and passwords in a series of Internet thefts affecting 420,000 websites. The gang dubbed CyberVor or cyber thief in Russian was identified after seven months of research by the security firm.

Hold Security reports that Russian cyber criminals collected over 4.5 billion records earlier this year and sorted through the data to remove duplicates. They were left with over 1.2 billion unique records and 542 million email addresses. The company says that the data collected by the hackers has not been sold, but is being used to spam social networks on behalf of other groups for a fee.

"Hackers did not just target U.S. companies, they targeted any website they could get, ranging from Fortune 500 companies to very small websites," Alex Holden, the founder and chief information security officer of Hold Security, stated. "And most of these sites are still vulnerable."

Holden says Hold Security has been in contact with many of the victimized website companies, but has not been able to reach all of them yet. The leak



Internet security breach

highlights that online users should protect their personal information and change their usernames and passwords frequently or risk identity theft. Cyber sleuths urge users to not use the same passwords for different online accounts.

"Companies that rely on usernames and passwords have to develop a sense of urgency about changing this," Avivah Litan, a security analyst at the research firm Gartner, told The Times. "Until they do, criminals will just keep stockpiling people's credentials."

70% smart devices vulnerable to hacking

With the advent of the Internet of Things (IoT), security and privacy issues have been the talk of the town for a while now. Adding to that, a new report released by the PC giant HP says that 70% of devices in the internet of things are susceptible to hacking. In the study, HP went through 10 smart devices, used commonly by people including webcams, thermostats and smart TVs.

Amongst the devices that HP tested, the company found each device had about 25 vulnerabilities. These included vulnerabilities regarding password weak protection software and password strength. These were found in eight out of the 10 devices that were tested.

In a statement from the company, HP said, "Late last year, we were hearing a lot about Internet of Things, and a bit about IoT security, but had not seen anything that focused on the complete picture of IoT security. So, we decided to start the OWASP [Open Web Application Security Project] Internet of Things Top 10 Project, which aims to educate on the main facets of Internet of Things security that people should be concerned with."

Why Facebook Messenger needs access to your phone

Facebook which received a lot of backlash for pushing its Messenger mobile app, has set up a web page to explain the app per-